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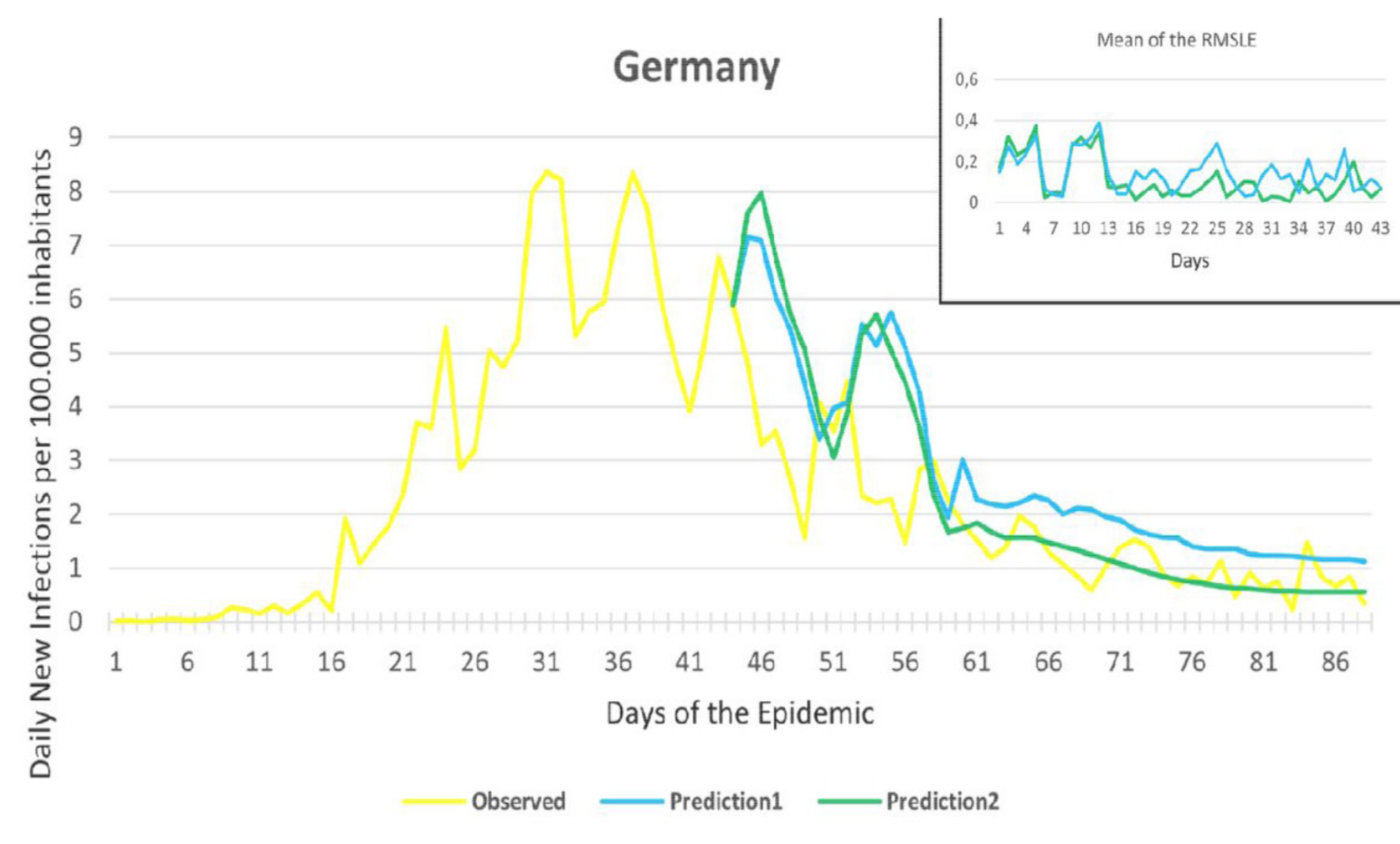
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Now, in their work, consultants analyse quantitative and qualitative data to understand a situation thoroughly and develop recommendations to improve things or solve a problem. This analysis often involves optimisation (finding the best possible solution from all available alternatives) or looking at the best fit (mapping real-world data points to an idealised pattern/model).

For such analysis that combines numbers and interpretations, modelling and simulations become very important. **Modelling means creating a simplified representation of a real-world situation, often using mathematics and data.**



Source: <https://www.medrxiv.org/content/10.1101/2020.04.17.20069666v2>

Predicting the Epidemic Curve of the Coronavirus (SARS-CoV-2) Disease (COVID-19) Using Artificial Intelligence

Simulations allow seeing what could happen by changing different variables and assumptions in the model.

While many advanced tools and software are available for modelling and simulations, consultants overwhelmingly prefer to use **Microsoft Excel**. Excel is highly flexible and capable, but consultants typically only use a small fraction of its capabilities, keeping it simple.